

Ventricular Tachycardia

Patient: *Daniel Brooks, 64*

Presentation

Post-MI history. Lightheaded.

- HR: 188 bpm
- BP: 90/60

Monitor

Wide-complex tachycardia.

Electrical

Ventricular reentry circuit bypassing normal conduction.

Cellular

Abnormal fast Na^+ channel depolarization in ventricular tissue.

EMS Medication

Lidocaine and amiodarone

Mechanism

Blocks Na^+ channels → suppresses ventricular automaticity.

If unstable → synchronized cardioversion.